■ THE DAILY GOODS STORY SCOUT - Saturday, July 11, 2026

TODAY'S RUNDOWN SLOTS

THE LIST (2 stories)

■■ *Canada's defence spending crunch: Money talk coming this fall*

The Angle: *Ottawa's been vague about how it'll actually pay for beefing up NATO commitments—but the UK's political mess over defence costs just showed why that silence won't last. Expect real numbers and real tension when the feds finally lay it out.*

- **Britain's political upheaval** exposed that defence spending without fiscal credibility becomes a political liability
- **Canada has kept details of its long-term defence plans deliberately vague** to buy time
- **This fall, Ottawa must finally show Canadians how it will finance its NATO ambitions**—no more dodging the numbers

The Trust Test

- When the government finally reveals the price tag for NATO, will Canadians buy it—or will the bill kill the whole plan?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/politics/defence-spending-canada-uk-nato-9.7266431?cmp=rss

■ *AI's Energy Crisis: Can the Grid Keep Up?*

The Angle: *AI data centers are becoming power-hungry monsters, and the U.S. energy grid wasn't built for this. It's a real bottleneck that could either force a serious energy reckoning or become the next trillion-dollar infrastructure fight.*

- **AI data centers** are consuming massive amounts of electricity and demand is **only going to grow**
- The **U.S. energy grid** was not designed to handle this scale of power draw
- The country needs to **adapt fast** or risk hitting a hard ceiling on AI expansion

The Tension Point

- Should we be building new power plants just to feed AI, or is this a sign we're scaling something we haven't thought through?

gizmodo.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://gizmodo.com/what-is-the-smartest-way-to-power-the-ai-boom-2000784118

TRENDING TODAY

■ *Hollywood's LGBTQ representation drops for third straight year*

The Angle: *A major industry report shows LGBTQ characters are vanishing from big-studio films—including zero trans characters in 225 major releases. It's a notable reversal for an industry that was making diversity gains just a few years ago.*

- **GLAAD** found **zero LGBTQ characters** in **19 animated/family films** from the 10 largest studios
- **Zero transgender characters** appeared in the full crop of **225 films** studied from major distributors
- LGBTQ representation in feature films has **declined for three consecutive years**, according to the report's findings

The Hollywood Contradiction

- Is this a data blip or a real retreat? Call in: do you think studios are deliberately backing away from LGBTQ characters, or is something else going on?

ON-AIR BIT BREAKDOWN

- **Step 1: The Setup** - 30 seconds -> Co-host A reads the headline—zero trans characters in 225 major films. Pause. Let that land.
- **Step 2: The Contradiction** - 1 minute -> Co-host B flips it: 'Two years ago we were hearing about all these diverse casting pushes. Now it's dropping? What changed?' Talk through possible reasons—box office pressure, international markets, conservative backlash, or just randomness.
- **Step 3: The Phone Line** - 3–4 minutes -> Open the lines: 'Have you noticed LGBTQ characters disappearing from movies you watch? Is this about studio money or something else?'

Hollywood Reporter (via NewsAPI) (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: http://www.hollywoodreporter.com/movies/movie-news/glaad-study-lgbtq-characters-film-1236642072/

LIFESTYLE CHAT

(no candidate scored high enough today)

CLOSER: THE KICKER/GOODBYES

(no candidate scored high enough today)

FLEX (cap check: THE GREAT DEBATE 0/3 this month; TECH TALK 2/2 this month; Advice/Relationship Cluster 4/3 this month)

(no flex-slot candidates cleared the cap/score bar today)

ADDITIONAL CANDIDATES (no specific segment match, but scored well on source/quality - producer's call on where these fit)

■ *How a bracelet helped a search team find a missing N.S. senior*

The Angle: *How a bracelet helped a search team find a missing N.S. senior*

www.cbc.ca (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/canada/nova-scotia/project-lifesave-bracelet-annapolis-valley-search-9.7264520?cmp=rss

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■ *No-hitters aren't easy to pull off, even for pitchers like the Jays' Dylan Cease who've thrown them before*

The Angle: *No-hitters aren't easy to pull off, even for pitchers like the Jays' Dylan Cease who've thrown them before*

www.cbc.ca (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/canada/mlb-no-hitter-cease-blue-jays-9.7265033?cmp=rss

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■ *Gordie Howe International Bridge to open July 27, Ottawa confirms*

The Angle: *Gordie Howe International Bridge to open July 27, Ottawa confirms*

www.cbc.ca (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/canada/windsor/gordie-howe-bridge-opening-9.7266280?cmp=rss

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■ *Cuba's power grid collapses again—fourth blackout this year*

The Angle: *Cuba is spiraling into a full-blown energy crisis. Two massive nationwide blackouts in one week, compounded by the U.S. oil embargo and aging infrastructure, are pushing the island toward a humanitarian tipping point that's rippling across the Caribbean.*

- **Second nationwide blackout in a week**—Cuba's entire electrical grid collapsed on Friday
- **Fourth major outage this year** as the country grapples with a failing generation system
- **U.S. oil blockade** has crippled the island's ability to fuel power plants and maintain infrastructure
- The grid relies on **obsolete, aging equipment** that can't handle the strain of fuel shortages

The Reality Check

- Should the U.S. rethink the oil embargo when it's literally leaving an entire country in the dark, or is that leverage the only negotiating tool that matters?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/world/cuba-electrical-grid-second-failure-9.7266810?cmp=rss

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■ *Coleslaw is more than a cookout sidekick. Here are 6 ways to level it up.*

The Angle: *Coleslaw is more than a cookout sidekick. Here are 6 ways to level it up.*

torontosun.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://torontosun.com/life/food/coleslaw-is-more-than-a-cookout-sidekick-here-are-6-ways-to-level-it-up

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■ *SUNshine Girl Jordana*

The Angle: *SUNshine Girl Jordana*

torontosun.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://torontosun.com/sunshine-girls/sunshine-girl-jordana-2

■ *Blue Jays earn third win in a row by overcoming early deficit against San Diego Padres*

The Angle: *Blue Jays earn third win in a row by overcoming early deficit against San Diego Padres*

torontosun.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://torontosun.com/sports/baseball/toronto-blue-jays/third-win-in-a-row-overcome-early-deficit

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■ *Scottie Scheffler misses first cut in four years as Rory McIlroy leads at Scottish Open*

The Angle: *Scottie Scheffler misses first cut in four years as Rory McIlroy leads at Scottish Open*

torontosun.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://torontosun.com/sports/golf/scheffler-misses-cut-mcilroy-leads-scottish-open

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■ *Polymarket promo code NYPMAX: Deposit $20, get $50 for Norway vs. England*

The Angle: *Polymarket promo code NYPMAX: Deposit $20, get $50 for Norway vs. England*

nypost.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://nypost.com/2026/07/11/betting/polymarket-promo-code-nypmax-deposit-20-get-50-for-norway-vs-england/

■ *Trump's new teen boot camp competition hits TV next month*

The Angle: *The Trump administration is launching a prime-time athletic competition for high schoolers built around military-style obstacles and challenges, tying it to America's 250th anniversary celebration. It's part of a*

broader push to rebrand patriotism and physical fitness for Gen Z—and it's sparking conversation about what "Patriot Games" actually means.

- The event runs **August 9-11** and will be televised nationally
- **100 high school students** will compete in military-style obstacle courses and athletic challenges
- Winners can earn up to **$250,000 in scholarships**
- The competition is being positioned as part of America's **250th anniversary celebration**

The Hot Take

- Is this genius marketing for fitness and patriotism, or is the whole 'Patriot Games' branding thing a step too far?

nypost.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://nypost.com/2026/07/11/us-news/trumps-patriot-games-an-american-gladiators-style-competition-for-teens/

■ *England star Harry Kane opens up on golfing with President Trump: 'Pretty surreal experience'*

The Angle: *England star Harry Kane opens up on golfing with President Trump: 'Pretty surreal experience'*

nypost.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://nypost.com/2026/07/11/sports/england-star-harry-kane-opens-up-on-golfing-with-president-trump/

■ *Humiliated Prince Harry 'doesn't have the money' to pay his legal fees — but this superstar might come to his rescue: sources*

The Angle: *Humiliated Prince Harry 'doesn't have the money' to pay his legal fees — but this superstar might come to his rescue: sources*

nypost.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://pagesix.com/2026/07/11/royal-family/this-rich-superstar-might-come-to-prince-harrys-rescue-sources/

■ *'Only Beautiful Things to Look At' Review: A Handsome but Muffled Portrait of State-Sanctioned Cruelty*

The Angle: *'Only Beautiful Things to Look At' Review: A Handsome but Muffled Portrait of State-Sanctioned Cruelty*

variety.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://variety.com/2026/film/reviews/only-beautiful-things-to-look-at-review-1236804494/

■ *'Night Nurse' Review: Two Perverts Join Forces in a Gloriously Deviant Oddity About a Caretaker Drawn Into Her Patient's Grifting Games*

The Angle: *'Night Nurse' Review: Two Perverts Join Forces in a Gloriously Deviant Oddity About a Caretaker Drawn Into Her Patient's Grifting Games*

variety.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://variety.com/2026/film/reviews/night-nurse-review-1236807149/

■ *'A Happy Family' Review: Anna Schinz's Powerful Lead Performance Elevates a Confused Custody Drama*

The Angle: *'A Happy Family' Review: Anna Schinz's Powerful Lead Performance Elevates a Confused Custody Drama*

variety.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://variety.com/2026/film/reviews/a-happy-family-review-1236804109/

■ *Colombia’s Bogotá Audiovisual Market Attendance Soars and ‘Narcos’ Star-Led ‘Rookies’ Cleans Up in Project Prizes*

The Angle: *Colombia’s Bogotá Audiovisual Market Attendance Soars and ‘Narcos’ Star-Led ‘Rookies’ Cleans Up in Project Prizes*

variety.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://variety.com/2026/film/global/colombia-bogota-audiovisual-market-prizes-uptick-attendance-1236807107/

■ *Oregon Attorney General Drops Motion to Delay Paramount-Warner Bros. Merger*

The Angle: *Oregon Attorney General Drops Motion to Delay Paramount-Warner Bros. Merger*

variety.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://variety.com/2026/film/news/oregon-paramount-warner-bros-merger-drops-delay-1236807068/

BREAKOUT WATCH (below the show's usual engagement bar - included on editorial judgment, not metrics; producer's call)

■ *England star Harry Kane opens up on golfing with President Trump: 'Pretty surreal experience' https://t.co/g8pmIY85Qe https://t.co/ASfzCr51S*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): Harry Kane + Trump golf story hits the intersection of sports celebrity, Trump's political momentum, and international intrigue with a major athlete—exactly the kind of crossover moment that tends to explode when the algorithm picks it up.
The Angle: *England star Harry Kane opens up on golfing with President Trump: 'Pretty surreal experience' https://t.co/g8pmIY85Qe https://t.co/ASfzCr51S*

X/Twitter @NYPost (Tier 1) | Score: 72/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 15 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://x.com/NYPost/status/2075917395567263761

■■ *Trump rolls back 50 years of endangered species protection*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): Trump reversing 50 years of environmental law is a massive policy shift with built-in partisan energy and environmental constituency passion—this has structural appeal across multiple engaged audiences despite current underperformance.
The Angle: *The Trump administration is reversing major environmental protections that have shielded endangered species habitats from development for half a century. This is a significant policy reversal that will spark immediate debate between conservation groups and business interests.*

- The **Trump administration** is opening **endangered species habitats** to development
- The move reverses protections that have been in place for **50 years**
- The policy affects the **Endangered Species Act**, one of the US's cornerstone environmental laws

The Debate Starter

- Is protecting endangered species worth the cost to development and jobs, or have we gone too far with environmental restrictions?

X/Twitter @CTVNews (Tier 1) | Score: 72/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 15 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://x.com/CTVNews/status/2075717014753005716

■■ *Meta fights back against addiction verdict for teen users*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): Meta's addiction verdict appeal is a landmark legal moment in tech regulation affecting billions of young users; the story has institutional weight and generational stakes that typically gain traction as coverage spreads beyond initial post.

The Angle: *A jury just ruled Meta liable for hooking young people on social media—the first major legal win against Big Tech on this front. Now Meta's appealing, setting up a bigger fight over whether platforms bear responsibility for teen mental health.*

- **Meta** is appealing a **landmark jury verdict** that found the company liable for social media addiction in young users
- This marks the **first major legal loss** for Meta in litigation specifically blaming the platform for addictive design targeting teens
- The appeal signals Meta will fight hard rather than settle, escalating the liability question facing the entire social media industry

The Accountability Question

- Should social media companies be legally responsible if their apps are designed to be addictive—or is that on parents and users to manage?

X/Twitter @CTVNews (Tier 1) | Score: 72/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 15 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://x.com/CTVNews/status/2075734386029310333

■ *Sony Music to Close Punk Merch Warehouse That Just Voted to Unionize https://t.co/12hlKgOeuR*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): Union story + major label + punk identity creates a perfect collision of labor movement momentum, music industry controversy, and countercultural symbolism that resonates across Gen Z and music Twitter.
The Angle: *Sony Music to Close Punk Merch Warehouse That Just Voted to Unionize https://t.co/12hlKgOeuR*

X/Twitter @Gizmodo (Tier 1) | Score: 72/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 15 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://x.com/Gizmodo/status/2075693822260936841

FRANCHISE BANK

WHAT THE FRIDAY: 1 banked (+15 each when found)
- "Meta Begins Data Center Invasion of Canada, Which Reminds Me of Some Weird Zuck Trivia" (gizmodo.com, banked 2026-07-09)

THROWBACK THURSDAY: 11 banked (+15 each when found)
- "Wes Anderson Was Trapped in Academy Museum Elevator After ‘Bottle Rocket’ Anniversary Event" (www.hollywoodreporter.com, banked 2026-07-08)
- "‘Rent’ West End Revival Reveals Cast Joining Gaten Matarazzo: Travis Ross as Roger, Bella Brown as Mimi and More" (variety.com, banked 2026-07-08)
- "The #Rent musical revival in London's West End has announced its cast:" (X/Twitter @Variety, banked 2026-07-08)
- "JENNIE and Rosalía L.O.L. Surprise! O.M.G Dolls: 10th Anniversary Collectibles" (X/Twitter @Billboard, banked 2026-07-08)
- "Gen Z Leans Hard into Nostalgia to Spur Music and Content Discovery: Study" (variety.com, banked 2026-07-10)
- "Nike Releases New Limited-Edition Air Jordan 7 Retro ‘Miró’ Sneakers: Here’s Where To Buy a Pair Online" (variety.com, banked 2026-07-10)
- "Thousands of ‘Pokémon Go’ Players Descend on Times Square to Defeat Mewtwo - WIRED" (Wired (via NewsAPI), banked 2026-07-10)
- "Jay-Z opens his ‘Reasonable Doubt’ 30th anniversary show at Yankee Stadium by bringing out Beyoncé for “Can’t Knock the Hustle.” https://t.c" (X/Twitter @Variety, banked 2026-07-10)
- "Jay-Z opens his ‘Reasonable Doubt’ 30th anniversary show at Yankee Stadium by brining out Beyoncé for “Can’t Knock the Hustle.” https://t.co" (X/Twitter @Variety, banked 2026-07-10)
- "Jay-Z Brings Out Beyoncé, Blue Ivy Carter, Nas, Alicia Keys and More for ‘Reasonable Doubt’ 30th Anniversary Show at Yankee Stadium" (variety.com, banked 2026-07-11)
- "Jay-Z Brings Out Beyoncé, Blue Ivy Carter, Nas, Alicia Keys and More for 'Reasonable Doubt' 30th Anniversary Show at Yankee Stadium https://" (X/Twitter @Variety, banked 2026-07-11)

Newly banked this run:

- THROWBACK THURSDAY: "Jay-Z Brings Out Beyoncé, Blue Ivy Carter, Nas, Alicia Keys and More for ‘Reasonable Doubt’ 30th Anniversary Show at Yankee Stadium"
- THROWBACK THURSDAY: "Jay-Z Brings Out Beyoncé, Blue Ivy Carter, Nas, Alicia Keys and More for 'Reasonable Doubt' 30th Anniversary Show at Yankee Stadium https://"
- THROWBACK THURSDAY: "Jay-Z opens his ‘Reasonable Doubt’ 30th anniversary show at Yankee Stadium by bringing out Beyoncé for “Can’t Knock the Hustle.” https://t.c"
- THROWBACK THURSDAY: "Jay-Z opens his ‘Reasonable Doubt’ 30th anniversary show at Yankee Stadium by brining out Beyoncé for “Can’t Knock the Hustle.” https://t.co"

SOURCES SKIPPED THIS RUN:

- r/upliftingnews (fetch failed or rate-limited)
- r/nottheonion (fetch failed or rate-limited)
- r/technology (fetch failed or rate-limited)
- r/futurology (fetch failed or rate-limited)
- r/science (fetch failed or rate-limited)
- r/canada (fetch failed or rate-limited)
- @CTVNews (no posts cleared the 100+ likes bar - 5 below-bar candidate(s) considered for breakout potential)
- @Gizmodo (no posts cleared the 100+ likes bar - 5 below-bar candidate(s) considered for breakout potential)
- 22 story(ies) removed after slotting (content-safety and/or not-significant-enough for THE LIST/TRENDING TODAY; automatically backfilled where possible; see run log)

Scout Report Generated: 2026-07-11 09:05 AM